Benchmark Diagnostics

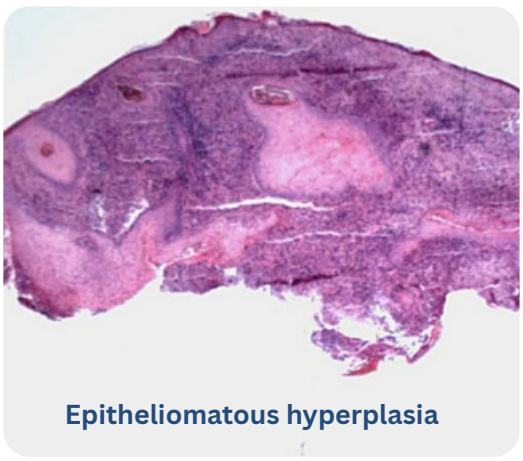
The Lab Report: July2026

Insights Beyond The Diagnosis

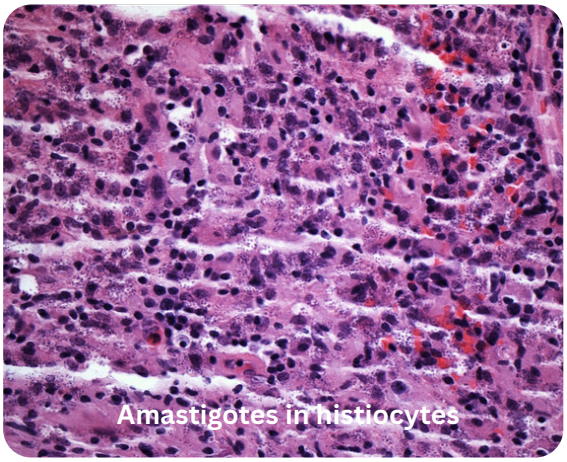
Leishmaniasis Mimicking Squamous Cell Carcinoma, Clinically and Histologically

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Epitheliomatous hyperplasia



Amastigotes in histiocytes

CLINICAL PRESENTATION

An 82-year-old Syrian female immigrated to the United States two years prior to her visit to a Northeast Ohio dermatology clinic for a single, nonulcerated plaque measuring 8 cm, involving the left eyebrow, temple, and upper maxillary region. There were areas of scarring and scaling. She complained of chronic itching without any other symptoms.

CLINICAL IMPRESSION

The initial clinical impression was eczematous dermatitis. She was treated with topical steroids without improvement. After failure with a course of oral antibiotics, a biopsy was performed to rule out squamous cell carcinoma.

HISTOPATHOLOGIC FINDINGS

Microscopic examination showed pseudoepitheliomatous hyperplasia with mild squamous atypia and dyskeratosis, surrounded by exuberant granulomatous inflammation. At higher magnification, multiple small intracellular bodies (amastigotes) were identified within the macrophages. These intracellular Leishmania forms are usually located at the periphery of the cytoplasm (Marquee sign).

Clinical Insights

- **Upward trend in leishmaniasis due to:**
  - Migration from endemic areas
  - Changing environment, expanding vector-reach into non-endemic areas
- **Clinician awareness:**
  - Lower threshold of suspicion
  - History of migration and travel
  - However, autochthonous cases are increasing in the South-Central US.
- **Clinical clues:**
  - History of exposure to endemic areas
  - Atypical cutaneous presentation
    - long-lasting, painless skin ulcers
    - Healing with depressed scars due to destruction of supportive tissue “skin collapse scar.” (*Evident in the clinical photo above)*

For further awareness: American Academy of Dermatology's 4-part educational module, "Climate Change and Cutaneous Diseases," hosted on the AAD Basic Curriculum website, to bridge professional knowledge gaps

“Questions or cases to discuss? We’re always happy to review.”

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